Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)			
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)	**English Language and Literature and Social and Cultural Anthropology**	Interdisciplinary framework:	Culture, identity, expression
Research question:	**How does the televisión programme Pingu utilise nonverbal communication in order to tell a story which can be understood by a global audience?**		

Assessment details		
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**2**	The research question is linguistically clear but not immediately appropriate for an interdisciplinary Essay. The research methods are explained in terms of links to DP subjects, though the subsequent illustrative analysis of a single scene from the cartoon is a narrow base for the conclusions drawn. Structural conventions are not well enough executed to support the Essay: there is no table of contents or page numbering. An endnote system is used instead of a bibliography and referencing is sparse, sometimes absent.
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**2**	The author presents a modest amount of knowledge and understanding. It would have been good to know for context where, when and by whom Pingu was seen. The research materials used are few and mainly related to academic studies of acculturalisation and nonverbal communication. Terminology and concepts used are not prominent or evident in the chosen DP subjects.
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**2**	For analysis, the Essay leans heavily on claimed links to DP Social and Cultural Anthropology where the relevant area of inquiry is communication, expression and technology. These links are not at all obvious in the subject guide. For English Language and Literature, the non-literary text types include cartoons though their use is not developed in the guide or by the author. The line of argument is partially consistent at best.
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**3**	Discussion focuses on gestural modes of communication and acculturation, though the conclusion is unclear in its evaluation of relative strengths and weaknesses in the evidence provided by Pingu. The Essay is generally short of detail which might have been used to draw stronger inferences. Sources are not evaluated.
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**3**	The first two paragraphs of the reflection offer a rationale for an interdisciplinary Essay and explain its narrowing focus. The final paragraph offers some insight into the author's growth as a learner and hints at elements of risk-taking in terms of the Learner Profile. This is creditable.

Total marks awarded	12/30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	While the Essay's focus is nonverbal communication across cultures and languages, the 'global audience' mentioned in the research question is not specified. Pingu was intended for 3-8 year olds (mainly reception class age groups) for whom language acquisition is not complete in a general sense. The reasons for the banning of many episodes at the time and subsequently in several countries are not considered, even though they remain of possible relevance to the Essay as a reflection of changing social values in early education. Pingu was made between 1986 and 2000 and is hardly visible today, being behind a paywall in many countries. These limits to its validity as a source are also not considered in the Essay. Nonverbal communication does not seem fully relevant to either of the chosen DP subjects as where appropriate both focus of forms of verbal communication.	